

Help me test binky

A 5-minute setup, then 14 days of mostly doing nothing.

Hi — thanks for opening this. I built a small Android app called **binky** (a beverage-tracking and brew-timer thing — log your tea, time your coffee, see your week at a glance). To put it on the Google Play Store, Google requires me to first run a 14-day test with at least 12 people. That's where you come in.

Please read the next two pages **before** you say yes — I want everyone going into this with their eyes open. If any of it doesn't fit, no offense taken; please just let me know so I can find another tester.

What is binky?

A small Android app for logging the drinks you have (tea, coffee, soda, water, whatever) and timing your brews when you make hot tea or coffee. Everything stays on your phone — no account, no internet permission, no ads, no tracking. It's free.

I made it for myself, polished it, and now I'm putting it on the Play Store. It will stay free.

What I'm asking you to do

Honest version:

1. Click a link I send you (on your Android phone).
2. Tap a button that says something like "Become a tester."
3. Install binky from the Play Store like any other app (it'll be free).
4. Leave it installed for **14 days**. You do NOT have to use it.
5. After 14 days, you can delete it or keep it — your call.

That's the whole commitment. Optional bonus: if you actually use the app and find a bug, tell me. But it's genuinely optional — just having it installed is what Google needs.

Before you say yes: is this right for you?

Quick self-check. You're a good fit if you can answer **yes** to all of these:

- I have an **Android phone** (not an iPhone — sorry, Apple users can't help with this one).
- I have a **Google account** (a Gmail address — the same one I sign in to Google with on my phone).
- I've installed an app from the Play Store before, or I'm willing to try.
- I'm okay leaving an app installed on my phone for two weeks even if I never open it.

If any of those is a "no," it's totally fine — just reply and say so. I won't mind at all; better that than committing to something that doesn't fit.

Difficulty rating

What	How much
Technical skill needed	Very low. If you can install Instagram or Netflix from the Play Store, you can do this.
One-time setup	About 5 minutes (clicking the link, installing the app).
Required activity during the 14 days	None. Zero. The app can just sit on your phone.
Optional activity if you want to play with it	A few seconds when you log a drink.
Storage space the app uses	A few megabytes. About the same as a couple of photos.
Battery impact	Effectively zero unless you run a brew timer. Even then it's small.
Cost	Free. Always. No ads, no in-app purchases, no premium upgrade.
Data shared with me or anyone	None. The app cannot connect to the internet. I cannot see what you log.

How to join (the 5-minute version)

Once you've said yes:

6. I'll add the email address you sent me to the tester list in the Play Console.
7. I'll send you back **a link**. It looks something like:
`https://play.google.com/apps/testing/com.binkyapp`
8. **On your Android phone**, tap that link. It opens a page in your browser that says "Become a tester." Tap the green button.
9. Below that button, tap "Download it on Google Play." This drops you on binky's Play Store page like any other app.
10. Tap **Install**. Wait a moment. Done — it's on your phone.

Note: opting in can take up to **a few minutes** to propagate on Google's side. If the Play Store page says "Item not found" right after you opt in, wait 10 minutes and try the link again.

If you actually want to use it (totally optional)

You don't have to. But if you're curious, here's the 30-second tour:

- **Open binky**. You'll see five drink categories (Hot Tea, Cold Tea, Coffee, Soda, Bog Standard Water).
- **Tap a category** to pick a specific drink. Or **press-and-hold** a category to instantly log the default drink (long-press is the fastest way).
- **Tap the chart icon** in the top right to see a weekly summary chart of what you've drunk.

- **Hot tea or coffee** show brew-time buttons (3 min, 5 min, etc.). Tap one to start a timer — when the brew's done it dings, even with the phone locked.
- **The three dots** in the top right open the menu: History (everything you've logged), Edit drinks (add your own), Settings.

What about my privacy?

Reasonable thing to ask before installing a stranger's app. The short version:

- **The app does not have internet access.** Not just "doesn't use the internet" — the Android system literally prevents it from reaching any website. I can't see what you log. Nobody can.
- **No accounts.** You don't sign in. You don't make a profile.
- **No ads, no analytics, no tracking.** I don't make money from this app and I have no way to.
- **Everything you log is stored encrypted on your phone only.** When you uninstall, it's all gone.

Full privacy policy: https://github.com/japanesus0/binky/blob/main/PRIVACY_POLICY.md

How to leave the test if you change your mind

You can opt out at any time, no questions asked. Two ways:

11. Tell me and I'll remove your email from the tester list. Easiest.
12. Or go to <https://play.google.com/apps/testing/com.binkyapp> on your phone and tap **Leave the program**.

Either way you can also just uninstall the app and forget about it. The only downside of opting out before the 14 days are up is that I might need to find a replacement tester, so a heads-up would help me — but you're not committed to anything.

Found a bug? (totally optional)

If anything goes weird — the app crashes, a button doesn't do what you expect, the alarm doesn't fire when you brew — please tell me. A one-line email is enough; you don't need to write a report.

Helpful but not required:

- What you were doing when it happened.
- Your phone model (e.g. "Pixel 7" or "Samsung Galaxy S22") if you remember.
- A screenshot if it's a visible glitch.

There's also a built-in **Settings** → **Diagnostics** screen with a "Copy" button — if anything misbehaves, tapping that and pasting the log into an email is the most useful thing you can send me. Don't feel obligated.

Contact

Reply to whatever channel you got this document on. Or email: app.binky@gmail.com

Thanks again for even considering it.